



IPO RUN HALTED

INDIAN COMPANIES had a great run last year in terms of raising money through IPOs. But the same cannot be said about IPO investors, as most newly listed companies have fared badly after listing. The BSE IPO index is down over 21 per cent this calendar year—significantly higher than the 5 per cent fall of the Sensex. Then, the IPO barometer is nearly 30 per cent away from its highs touched last year even as the Sensex is around 11 per cent lower than its record peak. The recent listings of eMudhra, Ethos and LIC, too, have all been tepid.

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR

₹1.39

**LAKH CRORE
AMOUNT
MOBILISED IN
THE PRIMARY
MARKET IN
FY22, UP 26.1
PER CENT OVER
THE PREVIOUS
FISCAL. THIS
INCLUDES
IPOs, FPOs AND
RIGHTS ISSUES**

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LOST CHANCE?

Drone Festival 2022 was a huge success with PM Narendra Modi (*in picture*) inaugurating the event and big names such as Adani Defence, General Aeronautics, etc., lighting up the stage. However, most drones on show were either focussed on agriculture or defence; consumer drones were not seen. The reason cited by many—commercial and defence is where the money is. But is the industry ignoring a big opportunity?

—NIDHI SINGAL



PHOTO BY ANI

MARUTI ADDS MUSCLE

India's largest passenger carmaker Maruti Suzuki India (MSIL) is all set to begin construction of its largest plant at Kharkhoda in Haryana with a total investment of ₹18,000 crore. According to R.C. Bhargava, Chairman of MSIL, it would not only be the largest investment for the company but in the country's automobile sector as well. While the first phase will be ready by 2025 with an initial production capacity of 250,000 units per year, once fully operational, the facility would be able to roll out one million cars every year.

—ARNAB DUTTA

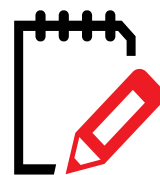


NEW VIRUS THREAT

As cases of Monkeypox rise, India's health ministry has issued guidelines on the management of the disease. Meanwhile, the WHO says the public health risk of Monkeypox at the global level is moderate, but it could become high if the virus establishes itself as a human pathogen and spreads to higher risk groups such as young children and immunosuppressed persons. As of May 26, 257 confirmed cases and 120 suspected cases have been reported to WHO from over 23 countries.

—NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA

Rise, Profit, Rise



THE BLUEST OF BLUE CHIPS—the Nifty 50 index companies—reported nearly 24 per cent growth in consolidated net profit at ₹1.63 lakh crore for the quarter ended March 31. But gross sales and total expenditure both increased by 21 per cent in the same quarter. Market watchers believe rising commodity prices capped profit growth in the quarter. Companies such as Tata Consumer Products, HCL Technologies, Bharti Airtel and Mahindra & Mahindra reported over 100 per cent growth in bottom line figures. On the other hand, Sun Pharma reported a surprise loss of ₹2,277 crore due to a rise in expenditure.

—RAHUL OBEROI